

UMAR FAROUK YUNUSA

Senior Backend & Full-Stack Engineer · AI/LLM Integration Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Backend & Full-Stack Engineer with 7+ years building and leading production systems across fintech, AI/data science, e-commerce, media, and enterprise platforms. Career spans hands-on full-stack delivery (PHP/Laravel, WordPress, CodeIgniter, Python, Node.js/NestJS) through to leading backend teams on event-driven microservices. Deep practitioner of AI-augmented engineering — production RAG pipelines, LLM-powered document parsing, and multi-agent workflows integrating Claude, OpenAI, Gemini, and Cohere APIs. Open-source builder: urlib3 and Wagtail contributor; creator of Aura CSS (1,000+ weekly npm downloads), Wazobia Agent, OmniFile, and LLMesh PHP AI SDK (active 2026). Experienced leading distributed async teams across South Korea, Canada, and Nigeria with EU/NA timezone overlap.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend	Node.js, TypeScript, NestJS, Express.js — REST APIs, WebSockets, Microservices, Event-driven, Serverless
PHP / CMS	PHP, Laravel, CodeIgniter, WordPress (7+ yrs) — full-stack apps, custom themes & plugins, WooCommerce
AI / LLM	Claude API, OpenAI, Gemini, Cohere — RAG pipelines, Pinecone, ChromaDB, multi-agent workflows
Python	FastAPI, Flask — AI/data APIs, Celery background workers, scripting & automation
Databases	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB, Elasticsearch — query optimization, ORMs, indexing
Infrastructure	AWS, Azure, Docker, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, CI/CD, Vercel, Netlify
Security	OWASP Top 10, OAuth2, JWT — applied across fintech and enterprise systems
Testing	PHPUnit, Pytest, Jest — Unit, Integration, E2E; 85%+ coverage standards

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Backend Engineer · **MUST Company** Mar 2024 – May 2026

South Korea · Remote · Full-time (Fintech)

- **Promoted to Backend Lead** on a new team after ~1 year, following initial role as a Laravel full-stack developer building internal fintech applications.
- Architected and led Node.js/TypeScript microservices fintech platform; designed event-driven architecture with RabbitMQ for high-throughput async transaction processing.
- Planned and executed migration of legacy PHP (Laravel) services to modular Node.js/TypeScript — established migration patterns, documentation standards, and reusable service templates.
- Optimized PostgreSQL queries and indexing strategies, reducing API response time from 3s → 150ms (85% improvement).
- Integrated Claude Code and Gemini into development workflows for accelerated refactoring, automated documentation, and test generation.
- Delivered WordPress full-stack projects in parallel with backend leadership duties; enforced OWASP and CI/CD standards via GitHub Actions.
- Mentored 5 backend engineers on microservices design patterns and security; contributed to 40% revenue growth through improved system reliability.

Backend & AI Engineer · [Manaknight Digital](#) Jan 2023 – Mar 2025

Ontario, Canada · Remote · Full-time

- **Year 1 — Software Engineering:** Built full-stack web applications and client platforms using CodeIgniter, WordPress, and PHP (Laravel) — delivering multi-tenant portals and e-commerce solutions.
- **Year 2 — AI & Data Science Team:** Moved to the AI team and engineered production RAG pipelines integrating OpenAI, Claude, Gemini, and Cohere with Pinecone and ChromaDB for LLM-powered fintech document parsing.
- Built RESTful APIs with Python (FastAPI) and Node.js; implemented background job processing with Celery and Redis; achieved average API latency <100ms.
- Designed multi-tenant architecture supporting multiple clients on a shared codebase; maintained 85%+ test coverage (Pytest, Jest) with full CI/CD via GitHub Actions.

Technical Lead · [Edawhtechnologies](#) Jan 2023 – Apr 2024

Ibadan, Oyo State, Nigeria · Part-time

- Continued part-time technical leadership while at Manaknight — overseeing ongoing client project delivery, architecture decisions, and mentoring the local engineering team.
- Reviewed and approved system designs; maintained quality standards on active projects across web and mobile platforms.

Full-Stack Developer · [Edawhtechnologies](#) Mar 2021 – Dec 2022

Ibadan, Oyo State, Nigeria · Full-time (Software Consultancy)

- Led end-to-end full-stack delivery across web, backend, and mobile — PHP/Laravel, Python, JavaScript — from architecture through production deployment.
- Architected backend for Nigeria's national COVID travel portal processing large daily submissions; built media platform backend supporting high concurrent users.
- Delivered custom WordPress solutions (themes, plugins, WooCommerce, REST API integrations) and built Python automation scripts for client data processing pipelines.
- Delivered MVPs concept-to-production in 3–6 months; established code review processes reducing bugs by 40%; mentored junior developers on Laravel, OWASP security, and design patterns.

WordPress Developer · [GEM Centre for Human Capital Development](#) Oct 2019 – Oct 2021

Oyo State, Nigeria · Full-time

- Built and maintained institutional WordPress platforms; developed custom themes, plugins, authentication systems (OAuth2, JWT), bulk data import/export pipelines, and role-based access control (RBAC) systems.

OPEN-SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS & PROJECTS

Contributions

- [urllib3](#) — Contributor to the Python HTTP client library (100M+ weekly downloads).
- [Wagtail](#) — Contributor to the leading open-source Django CMS powering thousands of production websites globally.

Projects Built

- [LLMesh](#) — Open-source PHP AI SDK: 'The PHP AI SDK — works everywhere, including Laravel.' Framework-agnostic core with provider/adaptor packages. Covers RAG, evals, observability, cost attribution, prompt versioning, smart routing. (Active, 2026)
- [Aura CSS](#) (npm: useaura) — Lightweight semantic attribute-based CSS library, ~17kb, zero runtime. 1,000+ weekly downloads.
- [Wazobia AI Agent](#) — Multilingual AI chatbot for Yoruba, Hausa, and Igbo — bridging AI accessibility for West African users.
- [OmniFile](#) — AI-powered desktop file manager (Mac & Windows). 100% local/private — smart folder organization, offline transcription, deep content search.
- [osbts](#) (npm) — TypeScript backend code generation CLI. Scaffolds DTOs, Entities, Controllers, Services, and Enums with Swagger decorators and TypeORM.
- [Real Dev](#) — Developer knowledge platform and live talk show on YouTube (@realdevhq).

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science — University of Ibadan, Oyo State, Nigeria *Graduated Dec 2020*

ADDITIONAL

- **Remote Collaboration:** 7+ years in fully async remote teams across South Korea, Canada, and Nigeria — proficient in EU/NA timezone overlap.
- **Mentorship:** Mentored 15+ engineers across multiple organizations on backend architecture, security, and AI integration.
- **Languages:** English (Fluent), Hausa (Native)